

New Ground: What the Numbers Hide

新的起点：数字隐藏了什么

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The numbers were **brand new** and, **yeah**, they also seemed to **contradict** each other. A **councilor** praised the rise in enrolment; a **pensioner** in the same queue said the buses had not improved at all. “Your figures are **convincing**,” Professor Zhao said, “**but** they cannot describe what a commuter feels when the bus never comes. You **ought to** ask what the numbers hide.”

The team listed what they lacked. A single, **vivid** story is not enough; a hundred **forgettable** ones are not either. The **complexity** was real, and the schedule was **merely tolerable**. “The data **vary** by street,” Lin said, “and a **smelly** corridor can be more **harmful** than a missing sign. The corridor is **virtually** empty after eight, **but** the bus is **incredibly** slow all day.” A **naughty** child had once kicked the bag of a **bully** down the stairs; the incident was **attributable** to a broken lift, not to a bad temper.

Being truly independent was harder than it looked. A **talented** student could **enhance** one section, **but** a **diverse** team needed the **flexibility** to rewrite the rest. **Accordingly**, they invited a **pensioner's** group to check the route. “I **shiver** when I think of the old plan,” a **comrade** said. “It was **predictable** and useless.” There was a **vacancy** on the committee, and filling it would **complicate** everything.

The **opponent** of the project was not a person **but** a habit. A **raging** argument about an **addictive** game, a rumour about **brutality** in the dormitory, and an **elective** course on manners all drifted through the same group chat. Lin found it **hurtful** and, at first, unbelievable. “Am I **nosy**?” Maya asked. “No,” he said. “You are **hopeful**, and that is rare.”

They agreed to **improve** the report, to **enrol** two more volunteers, and to **enrich** the sample with voices a spreadsheet cannot hold. The work was not glamorous; it was **merely** useful, though the queue was long. “**Yeah**,” Maya said, “a leader is someone who asks again.” She had grown used to the **smelly** corridor and the lady with the umbrella, and so had the president of the student union, who now stood beside them at the gate with wet hair and a personal note in his hand. Three months ago the same man had called the plan **forgettable**. “Good lord,” he said, “you have achieved something small. My major taught me to develop a model; you taught me to visit one. Give me the list.” The university press wanted a photograph for its college edition.

中文翻译

这些数字是崭新的，而且，是的，它们还自相矛盾。一位议员称赞入学率的上升；同一条队伍里的一位领养老金者却说公交毫无改善。“你的数据很有说服力，”赵教授说，“但它们描述不了一个通勤者在公交永不到站时的感受。你应该问问数字藏起了什么。”

团队列出了自己缺少的东西。一个生动的故事不够；一百个容易被遗忘的故事也不够。复杂性是真实的，而日程只是勉强可以忍受。“数据因街道而异，”林伟说，“一条发臭的走廊可能比一块缺失的指示牌更有害。八点以后走廊几乎空无一人，而公交车一整天都慢得难以置信。”一个顽皮的孩子曾把一个恶霸的书包踢下楼梯；这件事应归因于坏掉的电梯，而不是坏脾气。

真正独立比看上去更难。一位有天赋的学生可以改善某一部分，但一个多元的团队需要重写其余部分的灵活性。因此，他们邀请了一个领养老金者的团体来核查路线。“一想到旧方案我就发抖，”一位同志说，“它可预测，而且毫无用处。”委员会有一个空缺，而填补它会弄复杂一切。

项目的对手不是某个人，而是一种习惯。一场关于上瘾游戏的激烈争吵、一则关于宿舍暴行的传闻，以及一门关于礼仪的选修课，都在同一个群里飘来飘去。林伟觉得这伤人，起初也觉得难以置信。“我爱打听吗？”曼雅问。“不，”他说，“你有希望，而这很稀有。”

他们同意改进报告、再登记两名志愿者，并用电子表格装不下的声音来充实样本。这份工作并不光鲜，只是有用，尽管队伍很长。“是的，”曼雅说，“领导者就是那个会再问一次的人。”她已经习惯了那条发臭的走廊和那位撑伞的女士；学生会的会长也一样——他此刻就站在他们身旁的大门口，头发湿着，手里拿着一封私人短笺。三个月前，同一个人还说这个方案不值一提。“天哪，”他说，“你们做成了一件小事。我的专业教我开发模型，你们教我去走访一次。把名单给我。”校报想要一张照片用于学院版。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
but bʌt POS: prep	prep. 除了; conj. 但是; adv. 仅仅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r and nothing more
yeah ja: POS: adv	adv. (非正式) 是, 是的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r not only so, but
improve im'pru:v POS: vt	vt. 改良, 提高...的价值, 改善, 利用; vi. 变得更好, 增加 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v to make better; v get better
lack læk POS: n	n. 缺乏, 无, 不足; vt. 缺乏, 短少, 不足, 需要; vi. 缺乏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of needing something that is absent or unavailable
merely 'mi:li POS: adv	adv. 只 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. and nothing more
vary 'veəri POS: vt	vt. 改变, 使多样化; vi. 变化, 有不同, 违反 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be subject to change in accordance with a variable; v. make something more diverse and varied
being 'bi:ɪŋ POS: n	n. 存在, 性质, 生命, 人, 生物, be的现在分词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state or fact of existing
truly 'tru:li POS: adv	adv. 真实地, 不假 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in accordance with truth or fact or reality
virtually 'vɜ:tʃuəli POS: adv	adv. 事实上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in essence or effect but not in fact
opponent ə'pəʊnənt POS: n	n. 对手, 敌手, 反对者; a. 敌对的, 反对的, 对面的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by active hostility
enhance in'hæns POS: vt	vt. 提高, 加强, 增加 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. increase; v. make better or more attractive
diverse dai've:s POS: a	a. 不同的, 变化多的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. distinctly dissimilar or unlike
accordingly ə'kɔ:diŋli POS: adv	adv. 相应地, 因此, 于是 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in accordance with
complexity kəm'pleksiti POS: n	n. 复杂, 复杂性, 复杂的事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being intricate and compounded
pensioner 'penʃənə(r) POS: n	n. 领取抚恤金者, (英国剑桥大学的) 自费生, 为金钱所收买的人, 帮佣; [法] 领取退休金者, 领取抚恤金者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the beneficiary of a pension fund
flexibility ,fleksɪ'biliti POS: n	n. 弹性, 适应性; [计] 灵活性; 适应性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property of being flexible; easily bent or shaped; n. the quality of being adaptable or variable
talented 'tæləntɪd POS: a	a. 天资高的, 有才能的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. endowed with talent or talents
incredibly in'kredəbli POS: adv	adv. 不能相信地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. not easy to believe
convincing kən'vɪnsɪŋ POS: a	a. 使人信服的, 有力的, 令人心悦诚服的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. causing one to believe the truth of something
hopeful 'həʊpful POS: n	n. 有希望之人, 有前途之人; a. 有希望的, 怀抱希望的, 保持乐观的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or manifesting hope
shiver 'ʃɪvə POS: vi	vi. 颤抖, 哆嗦, 被打碎; vt. 使迎风飘动, 粉碎; n. 战栗, 碎块 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. shake, as from cold
vivid 'vɪvɪd POS: a	a. 生动的, 鲜明的, 鲜艳的, 活泼的, 逼真的, 清晰的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having the clarity and freshness of immediate experience
predictable prɪ'dɪktəbl POS: a	a. 可预言的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being foretold
harmful 'hɑ:mful POS: a	a. 有害的, 伤害的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. causing or capable of causing harm
complicate 'kɒmplɪkeɪt POS: vt	vt. 弄复杂, 使错综, 使恶化; vi. 变复杂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make more complicated; v. make more complex, intricate, or richer

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
vacancy 'veikənsi POS: n	n. 空, 空白, 空缺, 空虚, 空闲; [化] 空位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. being unoccupied
comrade 'kɒmreɪd POS: n	n. 同志, 伙伴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fellow member of the Communist Party
contradict ,kɒntrə'dɪkt POS: vt	vt. 反驳, 与...抵触, 与...矛盾; vi. 反驳 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be in contradiction with; v. deny the truth of
enrich in'ri:tʃ POS: vt	vt. 使富足, 使肥沃 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make better or improve in quality; v. make wealthy or richer
naughty 'nɔ:tɪ POS: a	a. 顽皮的, 没规矩的, 不适当的, 下流的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. badly behaved
bully 'bʊli POS: n	n. 欺凌弱小者, 土霸; vt. 威胁, 恐吓, 欺负; vi. 欺负; a. 特好的, 第一流的; adv. 十分 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cruel and brutal fellow; n. a hired thug
attributable ə'trɪbjʊ:təbl POS: a	a. 可归于...的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being attributed
addictive ə'dɪktɪv POS: a	a. 上瘾的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. causing or characterized by addiction
enrol in'rəʊl POS: vt	vt. 登记, 使加入; vi. 参军, 注册 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v register formally as a participant or member
brutality bru:'tælɪti POS: n	n. 残忍, 无慈悲, 野蛮的行为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a brutal barbarous savage act
raging 'reɪdʒɪŋ POS: a	a. 愤怒的, 狂暴的, 猛烈的, 使极痛的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. very severe
smelly 'smeli POS: a	a. 发臭的, 有臭味的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s offensively malodorous
elective ɪ'lektɪv POS: a	a. 选举的, 根据选举的, 选修的; n. 选修课程 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. subject to popular election; s. not compulsory
tolerable 'tɒlərəbl POS: a	a. 可容忍的, 可以的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being borne or endured
hurtful 'hɜ:tful POS: a	a. 造成损害的, 伤感情的, 伤害的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. causing hurt
nosy 'nəʊzi POS: a	a. 大鼻子的, 好管闲事的, 爱打听的; n. 大鼻者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. offensively curious or inquisitive
forgettable fə'getəbl POS: a	a. 容易被忘的, 可忘记的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. easily forgotten
councilor 'kaʊnsɪlə POS: n	n. 地方议会成员, 议会委员, 顾问, 评议员, 参赞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. A member of a council.
brand new phonetic unavailable POS: review required	崭新的, 全新的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.
ought to phonetic unavailable POS: review required	应该 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.